

Reporting Verbs Used with All Forms of Exclamatory Sentences

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Reporting Verbs

An **exclamatory sentence** expresses a strong emotion or sudden feeling.

Common forms include:

- . **What a/an + adjective + noun + subject + verb!**
- . **How + adjective/adverb + subject + verb!**
- . **Hurrah!**
- . **Alas!**
- . **Bravo!**
- . **Oh! / Ah!**
- . **Wow!**
- . **Fie!**
- . **What a pity!**
- . **How unfortunate!**
- . **What a surprise!**

1. Joy / Happiness — □□□□ □□ □□□□

Used when the speaker expresses great happiness.

Reporting Verb / Expression	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with joy	□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
exclaimed with delight	□□□□ / □□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□□ □□□
rejoiced	□□□□ □□□□
expressed great joy	□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
celebrated	□□□□□ □□□□

Example

Direct: He said, “Hurrah! We have won the match!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with joy that** they had won the match.

Nepali: □□□□ □□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□

2. Sorrow / Grief — □□□□ □□ □□□

Used when the speaker expresses sadness, grief, or sorrow.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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exclaimed with sorrow	□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
lamented	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
mourned	□□□ □□□□
grieved	□□□ □□□
expressed sorrow	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: He said, “Alas! My friend has died!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with sorrow** **that** his friend had died.

Nepali: □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
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3. Surprise / Amazement — □□□□□□□

Used when something is unexpected or astonishing.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with surprise	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed surprise	□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
marvelled/marveled	□□□□□ □□□□

wondered	□□□□□ □□□□/□□□□
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Example

Direct: She said, “What a beautiful painting!”

Indirect: She **exclaimed with surprise that** it was a very beautiful painting.

Nepali: □□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□
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4. Admiration — □□□□□□□/□□□□□□

Used when the speaker strongly admires someone or something.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with admiration	□□□□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
admired	□□□□□□□□ □□□
praised	□□□□□□□□ □□□
appreciated	□□□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: He said, “What a beautiful garden!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with admiration that** it was a very beautiful garden.

5. Regret — □□□□□

Used when the speaker feels sorry about something that has happened or has been done.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with regret	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
regretted	□□□□□ □□□
lamented	□□□□□/□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed regret	□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: He said, “Alas! I have lost my precious book!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with regret** **that** he had lost his precious book.

6. Anger — □□□□□

Used when the exclamation expresses anger or irritation.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed angrily	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

shouted	□□□□□□□
roared	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□
thundered	□□□□/□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
protested	□□□□□ □□□□

Example

Direct: He said, “What nonsense!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed angrily** **that** it was complete nonsense.

7. Fear / Fright — □□ □□ □□

Used when the speaker suddenly expresses fear.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with fear	□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
cried out in fear	□□□□ □□□□□□□□
exclaimed in alarm	□□□□□□/□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed fear	□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: She said, “Oh! There is a snake!”

Indirect: She **exclaimed with fear that** there was a snake.

8. Disgust — □□□□/□□□□□□□□

Used when the speaker feels strong dislike or disgust.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with disgust	□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed disgust	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
recoiled	□□□□/□□□□ □□□ □□□

Example

Direct: He said, “Fie! What a dirty place!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with disgust that** it was a very dirty place.

9. Approval / Appreciation — □□□□□□□□ □□ □□□□□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
praised	□□□□□□□□ □□□
applauded	□□□□□□□□/□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

appreciated	आपनी कुर्यातलाई
approved	आपनी कुर्यातलाई

Example

Direct: The teacher said, “Bravo! You have done an excellent job!”

Indirect: The teacher **praised the student for having done** an excellent job.

10. Encouragement — आह्वान

Some exclamatory expressions encourage someone.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
encouraged	आह्वान गर्नु
cheered	आह्वान गर्नु
applauded	आह्वान गर्नु
exclaimed approvingly	आह्वान गर्नु

Example

Direct: The coach said, “Bravo! You played very well!”

Indirect: The coach **praised and encouraged** the player for playing very well.

11. Excitement — □□□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with excitement	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed excitement	□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
enthused	□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: She said, “Wow! We are going to Pokhara!”

Indirect: She **exclaimed with excitement** that they were going to Pokhara.

12. Pain — □□□□

When an exclamation expresses physical or emotional pain.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
cried out in pain	□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□
exclaimed in pain	□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
lamented	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Example

Direct: He said, “Oh! My leg hurts!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed in pain that** his leg hurt.

13. Relief — □□□□

When something frightening or difficult has ended successfully.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed with relief	□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed relief	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
sighed with relief	□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□

Example

Direct: She said, “Thank goodness! We are safe!”

Indirect: She **exclaimed with relief that** they were safe.

14. Gratitude — □□□□□□□□

Some exclamatory expressions show strong gratitude.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed gratitude	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

thanked	
exclaimed gratefully	

Example

Direct: He said, “How kind you are!”

Indirect: He **expressed his gratitude and admired** her kindness.

15. Contempt —

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
scoffed	
mocked	
derided	/
exclaimed contemptuously	

Example

Direct: He said, “What a foolish idea!”

Indirect: He **dismissed the idea as foolish**.

16. Shock — □□□□□□□□ / □□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
exclaimed in shock	□□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed shock	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
was shocked	□□□□□□ □□

Example

Direct: She said, “Oh! What has happened?”

Indirect: She **exclaimed in shock** and asked what had happened.

☆ Special Exclamatory Expressions

A. “Hurrah!”

Meaning: Joy / □□□□

Direct: They said, “Hurrah! We have won.”

Indirect: They **exclaimed with joy that** they had won.

B. “Alas!”

Meaning: Sorrow / □□□□

Direct: He said, “Alas! Our friend is dead.”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with sorrow that** their friend was dead.

C. “Bravo!”

Meaning: Praise / □□□□□□□□

Direct: The teacher said, “Bravo! You have done well.”

Indirect: The teacher **praised the student for doing** well.

D. “What a...!” / “What an...!”

Usually expresses **surprise, admiration, joy, anger, etc.**, depending on context.

Direct: She said, “What a beautiful flower!”

Indirect: She **exclaimed with admiration that** it was a very beautiful flower.

E. “How...!”

Usually expresses strong emotion such as admiration or surprise.

Direct: He said, “How beautiful the scenery is!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with admiration that** the scenery was very beautiful.

☆ Master Classification

Emotion / Meaning	Suitable Reporting Verbs	□□□□□□ □□□□
Joy	exclaimed with joy, rejoiced, expressed joy	□□□□ / □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Sorrow	exclaimed with sorrow, lamented, mourned	□□□□ / □□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Surprise	exclaimed with surprise, wondered, marvelled	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Admiration	exclaimed with admiration, admired, praised	□□□□□□□□ □□□
Regret	exclaimed with regret, regretted, lamented	□□□□□ □□□

Anger	exclaimed angrily, shouted, protested	□□□ / □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Fear	exclaimed with fear, cried out in fear	□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Disgust	exclaimed with disgust, expressed disgust	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Approval	praised, applauded, appreciated	□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□ □□□
Encouragement	encouraged, cheered, applauded	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□
Excitement	exclaimed with excitement, enthused	□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Pain	cried out in pain, exclaimed in pain	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Relief	exclaimed with relief, expressed relief	□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
Gratitude	thanked, expressed gratitude	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Contempt	scoffed, mocked, derided	□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□ □□□
Shock	exclaimed in shock, expressed shock	□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Important Transformation Patterns

1. Exclamation of Joy

Subject + exclaimed with joy + that + clause

“Hurrah! We have won.”

→ They **exclaimed with joy that** they had won.

2. Exclamation of Sorrow

Subject + exclaimed with sorrow + that + clause

“Alas! He is dead.”

→ He **exclaimed with sorrow that** he was dead.

3. Exclamation of Admiration

Subject + exclaimed with admiration + that + clause

“What a beautiful flower!”

→ She **exclaimed with admiration that** it was a very beautiful flower.

4. Exclamation of Surprise

Subject + exclaimed with surprise + that + clause

“What a huge building!”

→ He **exclaimed with surprise that** it was a very huge building.

5. Praise with “Bravo!”

Subject + praised + object + for + V-ing

“Bravo! You have done well.”

→ The teacher **praised him for doing** well.

6. “Alas!” + Regret

Subject + regretted / exclaimed with regret + that + clause

“Alas! I have wasted my time.”

→ He **regretted that** he had wasted his time.

☆ Golden Rule

The word “**exclaimed**” alone does not tell us the exact emotion. We should identify the emotion first:

Hurrah! → Joy → exclaimed with joy / rejoiced

Alas! → Sorrow → exclaimed with sorrow / lamented

Bravo! → Praise → praised / applauded

What a beautiful scene! → Admiration → admired / exclaimed with admiration

What! You are here! → Surprise → exclaimed with surprise

Fie! → Disgust → exclaimed with disgustAAOh! I am frightened! → Fear → exclaimed with fear

What a pity! → Regret/Sorrow → regretted / exclaimed with sorrow

Thus, the best reporting verb in an exclamatory sentence is determined by emotion + context, not merely by the presence of an exclamation mark (!).